

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUS, IT'S ALL
HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
This month we teach you how to recognise and avoid Dark Patterns in UX. After that in Level-Up, learn more about iOS 13, and become a social media whiz with some apps. Finally, learn about the origins of Software Macros.



China's new gaming laws

To tackle the growing gaming addiction concerns, the Chinese Government has enacted new laws for minors. Gamers under 18 will be barred from playing online between 10PM-8AM and there will be restrictions on the time they can spend gaming every day. Restrictions are also being placed on how much minors can spend on games.

<https://dgit.in/ChinaGame19>

WHAT'S NEW

Google acquires Fitbit for \$2.1 Billion

Google's parent company Alphabet has announced that it is acquiring FitBit, the wearable company, for \$2.1 Billion by paying \$7.35 per share. Google's blog post mentions that this acquisition will help Google improve Wear OS and Google Fit, and introduce 'Made by Google' wearable devices in the market. Google believes that this will allow them to "bring together the best AI, software and hardware and thus, help spur innovation in wearables". Google has also explicitly mentioned that they will not sell the personal information sourced from Fitbit devices to any third parties and that this particular data will not be used for Google ads. This wasn't



enough to allay the concerns of a segment of Fitbit owners who've started ditching their existing devices post the acquisition news. Analysts see this move as Google's attempt to compete with

the Apple Watch. Google licenses its Wear OS to companies such as Fossil and TicWatch but does not manufacture the hardware itself. Google did not mention when it would be launching the first 'Made by Google' smartwatch or fitness tracker.

<https://dgit.in/GoogBit>

YouTube overhauls Terms of Service

YouTube recently made major changes to their Terms of Service which are being received by creators with mixed reactions. The recent revisions to the ToS has some vague statements which can be interpreted in a lot of different ways. The new ToS now reads, "YouTube is under no obligation to host or serve content." While this may seem contrary to what a video hosting website is meant to do, there's more to this than meets the

eye. YouTube has seen several controversies around videos which have edgier content that ends up offending certain parts of its demographic. On one



end, there's the free speech issue and on the other hand you have to keep advertisers happy by having a relatively safe advertising platform. YouTube

is now experimenting with placing ads on edgier content in order to address the demonetisation issues that's driving certain creators away from the platform. Also, the FTC's new guidelines requires YouTube to ask its creators to label content that's aimed at children. This will allow YouTube to not collect any viewership data from that video, thus, reducing the earning potential via ads for that video.

<https://dgit.in/YToS>



Instagram hides likes, Twitter hides replies

Instagram has removed likes from all posts on their platform in an attempt to help users feel comfortable about expressing themselves. In a similar vein, Twitter now allows users to hide certain replies that they don't want to see on their feed.

<https://dgit.in/IGnTwitterHide>



Mozilla, Red Hat, Intel and Fastly announce Bytecode Alliance

The companies have formed a new open-source group that focuses on "creating new software foundations building on standards such as WebAssembly and WebAssembly System Interface (WASI)."

<https://dgit.in/ByteCodeAll>



Jio, Airtel and Vodafone Idea announce tariff hikes

Major telecom service providers have announced tariff hikes for both, telephony and data services starting December 2019. Analysts estimate that these hikes could increase tariffs by 67% and data costs by 20%.

<https://dgit.in/TSPHikes>